16. ***Habitat II, 1996:*** The Second United Nations Conference on Human Settlements, called Habitat II, was held in Istanbul, Turkey from 3 to 14 June, 1996. The primary focus of Habitat II was adequate shelter for all and sustainable cities.

17. ***Kyoto Protocol, 1997:*** The third meeting of the Conference of Parties to the UN Climate Change Convention in Kyoto, Japan adopted the Kyoto Protocol (features discussed later) to reduce global emissions of greenhouse gases.

18. ***Millennium Development Goals (MDGs), 2000:*** At the United Nations Millennium Summit, the UN General Assembly approved eight Millennium Development Goals, all of which are interrelated, aimed at ensuring "environmental sustainability" (Goal-7).

Goal-7, aimed to ensure environmental sustainability, upholds:

- Target 7A: Integrate the principles of sustainable development into country policies and programmes; reverse loss of environmental resources.
- Target 7B: Reduce biodiversity loss, achieving, by 2010, a significant reduction in the rate of loss.
- Target 7C: Halve, by 2015, the proportion of the population without sustainable access to safe drinking water and basic sanitation.
- Target 7D: By 2020, to have achieved a significant improvement in the lives of at least 100 million slum-dwellers.

19. ***Johannesburg Summit, 2002:*** World Summit on Sustainable Development (WSSD) (also known as Rio+10) under the auspices of the UN was held in Johannesburg, South Africa, to assess the global situation and progress in implementing international agreements adopted at Rio in 1992 and at the 1972 UN Conference on the Human Environment in Stockholm.

The Political Declaration that was adopted stated that the members would undertake "a collective responsibility to advance and strengthen the interdependent and mutually reinforcing pillars of sustainable development, economic development, social